```
Output:
string(21) "3 is the magic number"
int(123)
```

It is also possible, with some caveats, to cast to and from compound types.

Constants

Some data doesn't need to change value or needs to be prevented from changing value. For these cases, we have constants. As the name suggests, these are fixed values and will retain the data they were initialized with for the lifecycle of your program. Constants can be declared anywhere in your source code and are available globally, which means they are accessible no matter where in your code you access them from.

Defining a Constant

Use the built-in function `define()` to create a new constant. `define()` expects two input values: a string, which will be the constant name, and then the value. The value can be any scalar, an `array`, `null`, or a `resource`. Objects (including `iterables` and `callables`, which are just special kinds of objects) are not permitted. Prior to PHP 7.3, it was possible to define a constant and make it case insensitive. This is now deprecated, and all constants are case sensitive. By convention, constant names are uppercase and words are separated by underscores:

```
define('MY_STR', "You can't change me");
define('MY_INT', 123);
define('MY_FLOAT', 1.23);
define('MY_ARRAY', []);
define('MY_RESOURCE', fopen(__FILE__, "r"));
define('MY_NULL', null);

var_dump(MY_STR);
var_dump(MY_INT);
var_dump(MY_FLOAT);
var_dump(MY_ARRAY);
var_dump(MY_RESOURCE);
```